It is better, perhaps, to seek an explanation for the qualitatively distinct character of the Kandahar epigraph in a different set of historical facts. One possibility is that the edict was specially composed for this part of his empire, which had formed part of the territory of many earlier conquerors. Local administrators may have felt that a confident and assured message was more appropriate here than one where the emperor's personal angst and spiritual metamorphosis were spotlighted. These officials had a familiarity with the world of Persia, where kings made triumphant proclamations about their deeds and battles in elaborate detail. So, composing a message which spelt out what Ashoka had achieved would be more in line with what monarchs in this part of Asia generally disseminated. For this reason, there are elements in it which have been described as similar to the great Behistun inscription of Darius in Iran, in which the facts narrated are counted from the king's succession to the throne, with the king stating that everything changed with his reign.[36] But Darius is shown as victorious over his enemies and protected by a god (Ahuramazda). Ashoka by contrast emphasizes personal humility and the ultimate triumph of non-violence.

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Afghani food has traditionally been rich in all kinds of carnivorous delights. A graphic description of this diet—including hunks of mutton, the head and feet of sheep, chicken, skewered meat, hot mutton stock soups, even dried meat—has been provided by a scholar of Afghan history and culture, Louis Dupree. Hunting game, particularly gazelle, markhor, ibex, quail, pigeon, and partridge, and eating fish were equally important to the average Afghan.[37] It would be nice to know even more about the range of food that ancient Afghanis ate, but the list of non-vegetarian delights is already sufficient to turn the stomachs of vegetarians, the evidence for the consumption of animal flesh being not exactly skeletal. In this kind of